

Fairy Tale Fascination

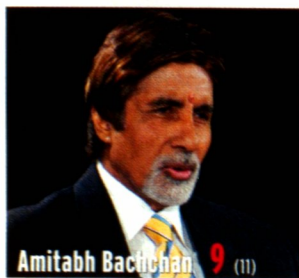
Despite an indifferent 2007, the three Bachchans sit right at the top of the fame pedestal basking in the glow of their well-knownness

Cary Grant once warned director Peter Bogdanovich to stop telling people he was in love with a beautiful woman, the actor Cybill Shepherd. When Bogdanovich asked why, Grant said, "Because they're not in love and they're not happy... Just remember, Peter, people do not like beautiful people." The results of the INDIA TODAY-ORG MARG-AC Nielsen opinion poll would seem to suggest the opposite. People, it seems, cannot have enough of picture perfect people, especially if they are united in holy matrimony or patrimony. What else explains the continuing fascination of respondents with Bachchan Inc.? An indifferent 2007 at the movies for father and son and an almost invisible one for Aishwarya Rai Bachchan (except for an appearance

in *Guru*) has done nothing to lessen their lure. They sit right at the top of the fame pedestal, basking in the glow of their well-knownness. Could it be that Indians do not like their celebrities to be everywhere at once? That they like them to be distant and discreet? Or is it just an enchantment with a fairy tale wedding and a Barjatya-worthy happy family? What else could explain Shah Rukh Khan scoring lower than Bachchan Senior and Junior despite a remarkable cinematic year? But though celebrity entertainers can just be, celebrity entrepreneurs have to become. So though the jury may be out on who is the richest among the Brothers Ambani, India seems to have decided the man who runs hard for his money is its role model.

by Kaveree Bamzai

Who will be the No. 1 hero this year?



SUMEET INDER SINGH

Amitabh Bachchan 9 (11)



SUDHANSHU MALHOTRA

Abhishek Bachchan 7 (8)

Shah Rukh Khan	6	5
Ajay Devgan	5	4
Aamir Khan	4	5

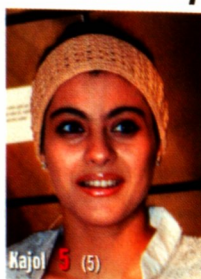
All figures in per cent
Rest: Don't know/Can't say
Figures in brackets indicate percentage in February 2007

Who will be the No. 1 heroine this year?



KALYAN CHAKRAVORTY

Aishwarya Rai 20 (23)



ARJIT SEN

Kajol 5 (5)

Rani Mukherjee	4	3
Asin	4	-
Nayantara	4	-

All figures in per cent
Rest: Don't know/Can't say

Who do you see as your role model?

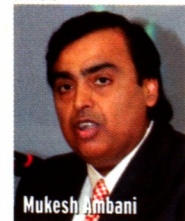
BHASKAR PAUL



19 (15)

Anil Ambani

SIPRA DAS



Mukesh Ambani

BANDEEP SINGH



Lakshmi Mittal

Mukesh Ambani	9	3
Lakshmi Mittal	6	4
Ratan Tata	6	7
Anil Agarwal	2	-
Rahul Bajaj	1	2
Azim Premji	1	1

All figures in per cent
Rest: Don't know/Can't say

Should politicians be allowed to head sports bodies?

31

48

YES

NO

All figures in per cent
Rest: Don't know/Can't say